

December

18

Heroic “Tigers”

Made up of former US Army pilots, The Flying Tigers engaged in combat for the first time in their distinctive aircraft. They were victorious in defending China against Japanese troops during World War II.

1941



Born this day

1946 Steven Spielberg, US director. He has directed many acclaimed films, such as *Jurassic Park* and *E.T. the Extra-Terrestrial*.

1980 Christina Aguilera, US singer. Known for her four-octave vocal range, she has sold more than 75 million records worldwide.

Also on this day

1865 The Thirteenth Amendment was formally adopted, abolishing slavery in the USA.

1898 French racing car driver Gaston de Chasseloup-Laubat achieved the first land speed record, at 63.159 kph (39.245 mph).

1974 Soldier Teruo Nakamura of the Imperial Japanese Army was discovered hiding on the Indonesian island of Morotai, unaware that World War II had ended 29 years earlier.

A step for migrants

2000

To raise awareness of migration, the first International Migrants Day was recognized by the UN General Assembly (UNGA). Millions of people around the world choose to migrate, while others are forced to migrate due to war or persecution.

1999 Tree dweller

US activist Julia “Butterfly” Hill ended her protest against the extensive logging of California redwood trees. She had spent 738 days living in one of the trees, which she named “Luna”.

